

João Paulo D. Lima

PhD Candidate in Development Economics

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Development economics, labor markets, informality, digitalization, cash transfers, causal inference.

EDUCATION

PhD in Economics – Université Paris Dauphine – PSL 2023 – present

Thesis: Informality in the Digital Era: Three Essays on the Brazilian Case

Supervisors: Mireille Razafindrakoto & François Roubaud (IRD/DIAL)

Marie Skłodowska-Curie Industrial Doctorate – PRESILIENT Project (Horizon Europe)

MSc in Economics – Universidade Federal do Rio de Janeiro 2019 – 2021

Thesis: Employment Effects of Cash Transfers: Evidence from Maricá

Exchange Program – Università degli Studi di Torino 2017

BA in Economics – Fluminense Federal University (UFF) 2014 – 2018

WORKING PAPERS

Lima, J. P. "The Effect of Internet Expansion on Informal Employment Opportunities in Brazil."

Presented at ANPEC 2025, RISE-SASE 2025, Göttingen Workshop 2025, PSL Summer Retreat 2025.

Lima, J. P.; Pero, V.; Waltenberg, F. "Can Cash Transfers Paid in Complementary Currency Boost Local Employment? Evidence from Brazil."

Updated and extended version of Lima, Pero & Waltenberg (2023). Under revision.

WORK IN PROGRESS

Lima, J. P. "Pix and Informal Transfers in Response to Health Shocks."

Third PhD chapter. Poster presented at PSL Summer Retreat, June 2025.

PUBLICATIONS

Lima, J. P.; Pero, V.; Waltenberg, F. (2023). "Evaluating the Role of a Cash Transfer Program in Promoting Local Employment." *Revue d'économie du développement*.

Castro-Alves, J.; Silva, S. L.; **Lima, J. P.;** Ribeiro-Alves, M. (2021). "Were the Socio-economic Determinants of Municipalities Relevant to the Increment of COVID-19 Related Deaths in Brazil in 2020?" *PLoS One*.

Waltenberg, F. et al. (2021). "Monnaie sociale, revenu de base renforcé et prestations d'urgence aux travailleurs [...] pendant la crise de la COVID-19." In: *COVID-19: Impacts économiques et sociaux*. Les presses de l'Université de Montréal.

SELECTED CONFERENCES & PRESENTATIONS

2025: 53° Encontro Nacional de Economia (ANPEC), São Paulo · VI RISE-SASE Conference, UFF · Göttingen Workshop on Ibero-American Development · Journée des Doctorants, MINES Paris-PSL · Second Summer Retreat, PSL Graduate Program · 5th PRESILIENT Workshop, Bucharest

2024: 3rd PRESILIENT Workshop, University of Lisbon · Causal Inference Workshop, Madrid · International Summer School on Informality, Split

2022: Second International Conference on Development Economics (ICDE), Clermont-Ferrand

2021: 49° Encontro Nacional de Economia, ANPEC

2019: XVI Encontro Nacional da ABET, Salvador

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

- Doctoral Researcher – PRESILIENT Project (MSCA, Horizon Europe)** 2023 – present
- Three-essay doctoral project on informality and digitalization in Brazil within a 14-partner EU-funded network.
 - Co-organized international coordination meetings (Lisbon, Bucharest); led the fellows' communication working group.
- Non-Academic Secondment – Development Perspectives, Ireland** 2025 – present
- Industrial secondment within the PRESILIENT MSCA programme at a non-academic partner organization.
 - Leading the design and implementation of a representative survey on personal values.
 - Completed UN Sustainable Development Goals Advocate Training.
- Doctoral Researcher – Institut de Recherche pour le Développement (IRD/DIAL)** 2023 – present
- Academic secondment under the PRESILIENT MSCA programme; conducting PhD research using IRD/DIAL infrastructure.
- Researcher – Fundação Getulio Vargas (FGV)** 2022 – 2023
- Monitored and evaluated the Na Moral program in public schools in metropolitan São Paulo.
- Researcher – Fundação Oswaldo Cruz (Fiocruz)** 2020 – 2022
- Microdata analysis and script development in R; co-authored academic articles on COVID-19 impacts.
- Data Analyst – Macroplan Analytics** 2021 – 2022
- Quantitative analysis for policy and business decision-making using administrative data.
- Field Researcher – Hjort, Moreira, Rao & Santini RCT** 2018
- Data collection (telephone interviews with mayors) for "How Research Affects Policy" (2,150 Brazilian municipalities).

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

- Teaching Assistant – Introduction to Statistics** Jul – Nov 2020
- Universidade Federal do Rio de Janeiro (undergraduate level).
- Founder – Study Group in Causal Inference** May – Jul 2020
- Designed and led a reading group introducing causal inference methods to undergraduate students, IE-UFRJ.
- Tutor – Mathematics for Economics** 2017
- Fluminense Federal University (UFF), undergraduate level.

GRANTS & FELLOWSHIPS

- Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions Industrial Doctorate (MSCA-DN)** 2023 – 2026
- Horizon Europe grant funding the PRESILIENT project (GA No. 101073560). Full doctoral salary and research budget.

DOCTORAL TRAINING

Coursework: Development Microeconomics · Economics of Migration · Machine Learning for Applied Economic Analysis · Estimating Spatial and Network Economic Models · Topics in Economics for PhD Students · Scientific Integrity (all at Paris Dauphine–PSL).

Workshops: Causal Inference Workshop, Madrid (2024) · International Summer School on Informality, Split (2024).

TECHNICAL SKILLS & LANGUAGES

Programming: R · Python · Stata · LaTeX · SQL · EViews

Software: Git · Power BI · Excel

Languages: Portuguese (native) · English (C2) · French (C1) · Spanish (B1) · Italian (B1)

ACADEMIC SERVICE

- Volunteer Collaborator,** Center for Studies on Inequality and Development (CEDE-UFF), 2021–present.
- Communication Working Group Lead,** PRESILIENT Doctoral Fellows Network, 2023–present.

REFERENCES

Available upon request.